

HOT SHOTS

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No one would have ever thought that capturing memories forever would ever be this easy, and as cheap as this. Digital cameras have really come a long way, have taken photography from being an expensive hobby for some, to something that's just a whole lot of fun. For that, they are in their own way a marvel. We receive cameras to test off and on, for our *Bazaar* section. Now it's time to get cameras from all across the country for a showdown.

This year we have an excellent selection of cameras that were sent by a large number of manufacturers—some of which we haven't seen for a while. The cameras are of all shapes and sizes, with prices suitable for all kinds of soon-to-be buyers.

A lot has changed over the years. The shift of users from film to digital cameras has taken place smoothly, but a few still opt for film cameras. Today, cameras are moving towards being simple and easy to use devices that need no prior knowledge or experience of using even a film camera. Then there are the cameras that have. There are also cameras that stand out of the crowd by offering features that were considered "expensive".

Under Rs 10,000

Samsung S1060

The Samsung S1060 is an affordable camera under the Rs 10,000 price bracket. The camera's key features are the 10.2 MP sensor and a 5x optical zoom lens. It comes with a 2.7-inch screen and the refresh rate on it is pretty good. The body and the buttons don't feel right somehow. The user interface has no such issues and is attractive and practical.

Like some of the Samsung cameras we received, the S1060 too has a guide feature to help rookie photographers through the features of the camera. All the other mandatory features expected by users are present as well.

In performance, it leads the pack of Under Rs 10,000 cameras

We test 32 of the most popular digital cameras on sale in India, to find which one suits you best

by a fair margin. The quality in general is great, but the best impression one gets is by the zoom lens. A 5x optical zoom on a camera priced this low isn't too common an occurrence. What's even more shocking is the quality of the lens. The camera gets some really impressive zoom shots with the lens. It's so good at times that it puts some of the cameras from the higher category to shame. It must be said that some of the colours turn out a little too saturated for most people's liking, the flash can be too powerful and that isn't necessarily a good thing as it wipes out all detail.

Although camera resolution isn't everything, a 10.2 MP camera at less than Rs 10,000 was unheard of a year ago. If you can ignore the few quality and design glitches of the camera, and just want performance, you can't go wrong with the Samsung S1060.

Samsung L100

The other Samsung in the Under Rs 10,000 category also comes in a rather boring shape and design. The trigger is pretty flat, and pressing it requires a little effort. The L100 is an 8.2 MP camera, as compared to the S series 1060 model. The L100 is a very light camera considering



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